

C1 ■ ALIGN Safety Matters

I care.

You count.

We matter.

IN THIS ISSUE

Lessons Learnt

Site information

Our teams are brilliant!

Safety Step-Up coming soon

Heart Health



Live from site

Aim High and SLAM award winners – presented by Derek van Rensburg, Surface Operations Director.



Head to page 6 to find out why they were recognised



What 3 things

3 things everyone needs to do:



ALWAYS wear the correct PPE – a reminder that our 7-point PPE is a minimum



STOP speeding – the speed limits are in place to keep yourself and others safe



CONTINUE to follow the haul road routes – whilst demobilisation is ongoing at the South Portal

Lessons learnt at Align



Action: ALL teams must be briefed on the following incident and discuss what it means in your area:

Tile: HiPo: Trip from Security Cabin

Location: North Portal

Incident: A Security Officer (IP) sustained an injury after falling while exiting the site cabin, which had a makeshift concrete block serving as a step. Although the officer initially continued working, he later experienced swelling and pain, prompting a hospital assessment.

Findings:

- **Improvised Step Hazard:** Concrete block used as step was unstable and not designed for safe access
- **Local Team Adaptation:** Lack of clear standards led to improvising. Block remained for a significant period without being challenged.
- **Inadequate Initial Triage:** Mobile Supervisor did not properly assess injury, resulting in a delay in appropriate medical response.
- **Routine Checks Missed Hazard:** Regular safety inspections failed to identify/address unsafe access arrangement.

Action: discuss with your teams:

- **Establish Clear Standards and Guidance:** All access and egress points must comply with agreed safety standards to ensure safe movement across the site.
- **Enhance Site Walkthroughs:** Safety inspections should include checks for non-standard or improvised structures, particularly around high-use areas such as cabins.
- **Review First Aid Provision:** Injury protocols should be reassessed across support roles—especially in sectors like security—where triage capability may be limited due to change management. Upskilling mobile supervisors to 3-day FAW (First Aid at Work) certification will support confident decision-making and appropriate escalation.
- **Improve Hazard Reporting Culture:** Staff should feel empowered and obligated to report unsafe conditions immediately using the SLAM or a similar system, even if the hazard appears minor or temporary.
- **Document All Modifications:** Any change to the site layout—no matter how small—must be logged and reviewed by a competent person to maintain oversight and accountability.



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Lessons learnt at HS2



Action: ALL teams must be briefed on the following incident and discuss what it means in your area:

Title: RIDDOR: Injury (fingers crushed) during lifting
Location: Curzon Approach

Incident:

A guiding system beam was being repositioned to allow in-situ drilling. A traffic marshal, also qualified as a slinger/signaller, instructed the telehandler operator to lift the beam slightly and move it forward. During the manoeuvre, two operatives manually guided the beam into position. As the load approached adjacent beams, the traffic marshal kept their hand on the edge of the beam, which became trapped, resulting in crush injuries.



Observations:

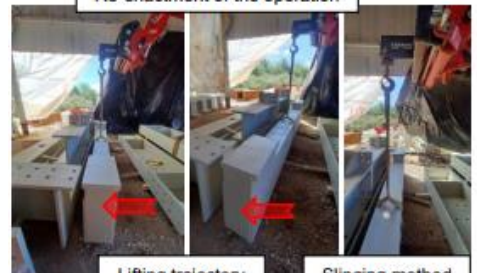
- **Hand placement awareness:** wherever possible, avoid manual handling of suspended loads by use of tag lines or push/pull sticks. Avoid placing hands and limbs near pinch points.
- **Dual-role involvement can introduce risk.** Avoid role overlap during lifting operations. Clear designation of roles improves communication and safety.
- When lifting, **always adhere to the lift plan**. No lift plan - no lift.

Action: discuss with your teams:

- Reinforce the '**Hands-off - step away – stay safe**' campaign through toolbox talks for all site personnel involved in lifting.
- **Update the Lift Plan and Schedule of Common Lifts** to include clearer, task-specific guidance on lifting configurations and equipment used.
- **Supervisor training to be reinforced** on setting people to work.
- Ensure all slingers performing lifts **are formally appointed and briefed**.
- Conduct a **review of current supervisory resources** to ensure adequate coverage across all working areas.



Re-enactment of the operation



Lifting trajectory

Slinging method

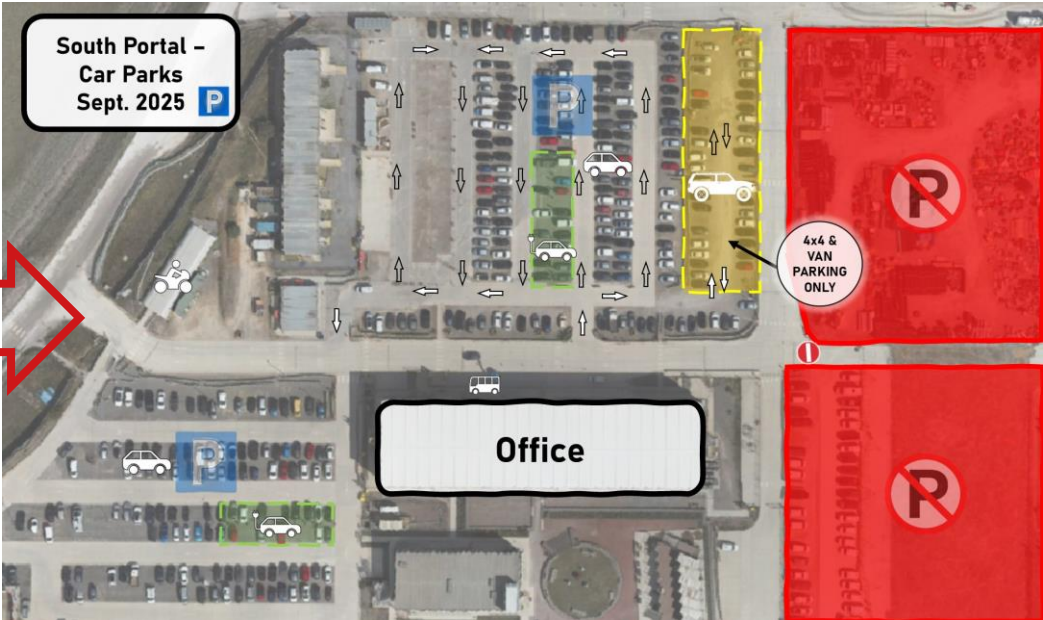


Hand crushed between the two beams

Site logistics information

South Portal car park closure

Please take note of the changes to the 4X4 car park at the South Portal.



Haul Road upcoming changes



Thank you to everyone for continuing to follow the changes keeping our roads safe



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Site logistics information

Know the site speed limits



Importance of speed limits:

- **Why slow down?** Speeding significantly increases the risk of collisions and serious injuries
- **Site-specific speed limits:** for different areas of the site. Areas with high pedestrian traffic or near equipment operations, generally 11 mph and 20 mph

Hazards and risks:

- **Blind spots:** discuss potential blind spot and around vehicles equipment and how to navigate them safely.
- **Pedestrian safety:** Always maintain a safe distance from pedestrians

Consequences of Speeding:

- **Disciplinary actions:** consequences of speeding, which may include warnings, or even termination of employment.

Aim High and SLAM awards

Recognition of excellent safety behaviour through Aim High observations and SLAM interventions in July & August:

Derek van Rensburg (left) presenting the awards.
Missing from photo: Colin Blake, Mark Crone, Peter McKeown and Ed Endean



Area	Nominee	Company	Observation
Tunnels	Martin Collins	Align	Martin has been critical in handing over the South Portal works ahead of the Key Date. His interfacing with the Earthworks team has been exemplary.
Facilities	Colin Blake	Align	Colin (maintenance team) is always positive, even though he is always there to do the jobs that no one else will do. He is a pleasure to work with.
South Portal	Peter McKeown	Align	Telehandler carrying gas bottle on forks (no cage). Stopped the driver and told him to pull up as you cannot carry bottles without a cage. The driver replied that there were no cages available.
Shafts	Richard Thornton	Align	Sorba carried out a prohibited lift whereby multiple lifts were carried out and the higher load could have damaged the lower loads lifting slings.
South Portal	Cary Pritchard	Align	Spot check carried out on a MEWP which was being used to access the top and sides of the porous portal (down line). Identified that the MEWP being used was overdue its 6 monthly thorough examination (expired 7-7-25) It was also noted that the Operator had not completed the daily pre-use inspection form.
South Portal Demob	David Gaitan	Align	ADT route passed very close to a redundant service chamber.
Earthworks	Ed Endean	Align	During the Exco engagement tour of the South Portal building, it was noted by the group that the standard of the works within the South Portal building was to a very high standard. Well done to Ed Endean (Align JV) and his subcontractor teams for managing the site so well in a very congested area.
South Heath	Satnam Singh	Align	Satnam takes time to teach the less experienced operatives about pipe laying. Great leadership.
Earthworks	Mark Crone	Align	A truck driving around site was not loaded safely. Materials could have fallen from the vehicle.
Earthworks	Florin Furniga	D&M	One man driving a Mercedes pickup van passed coworkers with excessive speed, avoiding a head-on accident with me at last moment.

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HS2 Safe at Heart Step-Up

The poster features a purple background with a blue staircase at the bottom. At the top left, the 'ALIGN' logo is followed by 'Working in partnership with' and the 'HS2' logo. At the top right is the 'Safe at Heart' logo with the tagline 'I care. You count. We matter.' Below this, the text 'We're good. We will be great.' is displayed in large white font. Underneath, it says 'Step-Up 2025: Break the performance plateau and prevent accidents, improve together, reset safely.' Three circular icons are arranged horizontally: a heart with a checkmark, a heart with a speech bubble, and a heart with a pulse line. Below each icon is a phrase: 'Care enough to act.', 'Count on each other.', and 'Together we matter.' The staircase has three steps, with the top step being the largest and containing the text 'Step-up safely together' and '29 September to 10 October 2025'.

ALIGN Working in partnership with **HS2**

Safe at Heart
I care. You count. We matter.

**We're good.
We will be great.**

Step-Up 2025: Break the performance plateau and prevent accidents, improve together, reset safely.

Care enough to act.

Count on each other.

Together we **matter.**

Step-up safely together
29 September to 10 October 2025

Step-Up 2025: 29 September to 10 October

At Align, during the Step-Up we will be taking a closer look at:

- Message from Mark Wild, CEO HS2
- Our safety performance
- Overall project progress
- Major risks
- Unexpected events
- Aim High and SLAM

Updates will be held on site using the mobile briefing stations.

Meet Gabriela Condrat, who joined the project 5 years ago, read about her journey from U&A's to Site Engineer

Gabriela recently joined the Earthworks team at the South Portal as a Site Engineer 🙌! You might remember her from the Undertakings & Assurances team (❤️).

Tell us about a skill, hidden talent or hobby that your colleagues might not know about?

I absolutely have the travel bug! I love exploring different countries and diving into their cuisines. My last adventure was in Rome and I had the best time walking around the ancient ruins which whispered tales of the past and indulging in delicious gelato. It was such a fantastic experience!

If you could work from any location in the world, where would it be and why?

Sicily, because that's where I rediscovered my love for coffee! They served an amazing espresso and then offered a little glass of sparkling water. Plus, the scenery is absolutely stunning to explore.

Tell us your favourite thing about your 'new' position?

After spending the last 6 years studying civil engineering, I was looking forward to diving into construction again. Right now, I'm getting the hang of building an attenuation pond, calculating the quantities of materials



needed, raising Hold Point Notifications, and handling Work Inspection Records and Material Acceptance forms. I've been taking surface levels using GPS for as-builts too. Plus, I'm learning about the permit process to break ground, delving into material testing, and even setting up markers for the site team where to dig/break ground. It's amazing how much there is to juggle as a site engineer! PS: Big shout out to **Tom Madden**! I really appreciate you putting up with me these last few weeks and kindly sharing your site / engineering knowledge.

What makes you most proud?

Being part of this amazing infrastructure project has been an incredible experience. I'm happy we delivered safely and on time, just as we promised. This project is my first in construction, and it's made a significant impact on my career. I've gained invaluable tools and knowledge that will serve me well in the future.



Recycling office furniture

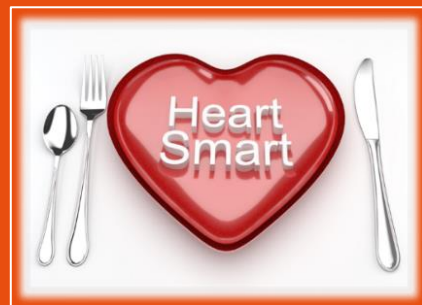
As part of the demobilisation of the HOAC offices in July, surplus office equipment found a new home with the Buckingham Boxing Club who used it to set up a classroom affiliated with England Boxing!



Diet hacks for a healthier heart

Keeping your heart healthy doesn't have to be complicated – even on site

Long hours, heavy lifting, and grab-and-go meals can make it tough to prioritise nutrition, but small changes to your daily diet can have a big impact on your heart health. Whether you're working on scaffolding or managing a crew, these practical diet hacks are designed to fit into your busy schedule and help keep your ticker strong. From smarter snack choices to easy meal swaps, here's how to fuel your body for the job and protect your heart for the long haul.



Do's

Fibre – lowers cholesterol by binding to it in the gut

Omega-3s – protect arteries and reduce inflammation

Potassium – regulates blood pressure by relaxing blood vessels

Antioxidants – from fruits & veggies, protect against cell damage

Whole grains – support healthy cholesterol and steady energy

Lean protein – fish, beans, and poultry help build strength without excess fat

Hydration – water helps maintain circulation and overall health



Don'ts

Salt – raises blood pressure by pulling more fluid into blood vessels

Trans fats – raise LDL ("bad") cholesterol and lower HDL ("good") cholesterol. This is your margarine's, fried food, frozen pizza's etc.

Added sugars – fuel weight gain, inflammation, and high triglycerides

Processed meats – linked to higher heart disease risk

Excess alcohol – strains the heart and increases blood pressure

